

See also: The Geneva Conventions 152–155 ■ The Universal Declaration of Human Rights 222–229 ■ The Chemical Weapons Convention 276–277



The results have generally been encouraging. By 2014, 70 million APLs had been removed and more than 1,544 sq miles (4,000 sq km) of mined areas cleared. The numbers killed or injured fell by an estimated two-thirds, although there were still more than 130,000 casualties between 1999 and 2018. And nearly 20 civilians were still being killed or injured every day by landmines and other devices in 2018.

Nonsignatories

Thirty-two nations have refused to sign, including the US, China, and Russia—all permanent members of the UN Security Council. India, Iran, Syria, and Libya are also notable nonsignatories. Reasons for not signing vary. The US, for example, has produced no APLs since 1997 and has donated almost \$2 billion to mine-clearance programs, but it has always maintained that APLs are essential for the defense of South Korea,

menaced by its neighbor North Korea. In 2014, the US did pledge not to use such weapons anywhere except to protect South Korea, but in early 2020, President Donald Trump's administration lifted the restriction on the deployment of anti-personnel landmines by American forces, saying that the ban could put US troops at a "severe disadvantage." ■

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Civilians should not be killed or maimed by weapons that strike blindly and senselessly.
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Arms Control Association

The Diana effect

A number of high-profile campaigners have lent their support to the fight against APLs, including British actor Daniel Craig, a UN-appointed advocate for mine removal, but none has influenced public opinion more than Diana, Princess of Wales. In January 1997, before the Ottawa Treaty had been adopted, as patron of the HALO Trust (the world's largest anti-mine charity) and as a guest of the International Red Cross, she visited a minefield in Angola, just one of hundreds that were planted during the country's civil war. Reported in media headlines around the globe, Diana's identification with—and very public support for—the victims of Angola's landmines sparked the world's outrage and helped build support for a ban on mines. In early August 1997, 3 weeks before her death, she visited landmine survivors in Bosnia and Herzegovina, which was also littered with minefields.



Diana, Princess of Wales, visits a minefield in Angola. Her son, Prince Harry, is now the patron of the HALO Trust.